

Influence_Consensus_agr_dis - In society, does Agriculture alone generally have a direct effect on Discrimination, or are observed relationships primarily indirect? If a direct effect exists, is it negative, none, negligible, or positive? What would be a reasonable normalized magnitude for this influence on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00? Please only provide evidence for only direct influences

Agriculture alone has a direct positive effect on discrimination, primarily by perpetuating racial and gender inequalities within agricultural systems. Historical and ongoing policies in U.S. agriculture have directly contributed to racial discrimination against Black farmers through unequal access to land, education, and financial assistance, reinforcing structural inequities (Hutchins & De Marinis, 2025; Van Sant et al., 2022; Fagundes et al., 2019). Gender discrimination is also directly embedded in agricultural practices and policies, with female farmers facing barriers such as limited access to land, credit, and government support, resulting in lower productivity and food insecurity compared to male counterparts (Reddy, 2024; Shortall & Marangudakis, 2022; Nchanji et al., 2020; Das, 2020). Urban agriculture, despite its social benefits, can also directly reproduce race- and class-based disparities rather than dismantle them (Reynolds, 2014; Nichols & Carter, 2023). These direct influences of agriculture on discrimination are substantial but vary by context; a reasonable normalized magnitude for this influence would be moderately positive around +0.4 to +0.6, reflecting a clear but not absolute reinforcement of discriminatory structures within agricultural sectors (Hutchins & De Marinis, 2025; Van Sant et al., 2022; Reddy, 2024).

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